Subclass 500

Student visa

Visit Australia to participate in a course of study.

Step by step

Step 1

Before you apply

Outside Australia: Apply for your visa with enough time before your course starts. For an indication of processing times for this visa, use the visa processing time guide tool *(/visas/getting-a-visa/visa-processing-times/global-visa-processing-times)*. This will show the processing times for recently decided applications. It is a guide only and not specific to your application.

In Australia: If you are eligible to apply in Australia, allow plenty of time to apply for your next visa. Applying early helps avoid problems if unexpected issues arise before your current substantive visa expires.

Organise health exams

You might need to have health examinations *(/help-support/meeting-our-requirements/health)*. You can complete them before you apply.

Find out the examinations you need *(/help-support/meeting-our-requirements/health)* and how to arrange them if you want to have them before you apply.

Get help with your application

Only some people can help you with your application. If you appoint someone to give you immigration assistance they must be:

- a registered migration agent *(/help-support/who-can-help-with-your-application/using-a-migration-agent)*
- a legal practitioner *(/help-support/who-can-help-with-your-application/using-a-legal-practitioner)*, or
- an exempt person *(/help-support/who-can-help-with-your-application/exempt-person)*.

You can appoint anyone to receive documents *(/help-support/who-can-help-with-your-application/authorised-recipents)* on your behalf relating to your visa matter.

Ask a question

Have a valid passport

You and your family members must hold a valid passport in order to lodge a Student visa application.

If you are in Australia and your current passport expires, you will need to renew it before you apply for your Student visa.

Step 2

Gather your documents

To see what you need to give us, use the Document Checklist Tool *(/visas/web-evidentiary-tool)*. Before you use this tool please read the disclaimer *(/visas/getting-a-visa/visa-listing/student-500/disclaimer-for-document-checklist)*.

Enter your country of passport and education provider to get an accurate document checklist. Choose the option 'I have not decided on a provider yet' in the tool if you have not yet chosen a provider.

The tool will tell you what evidence you need to provide. If the tool says you need to give us evidence of a certain thing (e.g. English capability), select 'Show steps' to see what kind of evidence we might accept.

Re-check the document checklist based on the country of passport and education provider just before you submit your application to be sure you have used the most current list, and to ensure that you have provided all documents that we need to assess your application.

The Document Checklist Tool is routinely updated twice a year on 31 March and 30 September but can also be updated at any time.

Provide accurate information

Provide accurate information. See what happens if you can't prove your identity or don't provide true information *(/help-support/meeting-our-requirements/providing-accurate-information)*.

Identity documents

We need proof of your identity. If you cannot prove your identity:

- we will refuse your visa application
- we might not grant you another visa for 10 years
- we might not grant any family members you listed on your application a visa for 10 years

Provide the pages of your current passport showing your photo, personal details, and passport issue and expiry dates.

Also provide:

- a national identity card, if you have one
- proof of change of name

Documents that prove a change of name include:

- a marriage or divorce certificate
- change of name documents from an Australian Registry of Births, Deaths and Marriages, or the relevant overseas authority
- documents that show other names you have been known by

Confirmation of enrolment, letters of support and acceptance forms

Attach the required documents according to your situation.

Confirmation of Enrolment

Provide a Confirmation of Enrolment (CoE) in a full time course registered on the Commonwealth Register of Institutions and courses for Overseas Students (CRICOS) *(https://cricos.education.gov.au/)* for all intended courses.

Your CoE must be valid at time of lodgement and when we decide your visa application. A CoE is no longer valid if it is cancelled or the course is complete. A new CoE will need to be attached to ImmiAccount to remain eligible for a student visa.

Australian Department of Foreign Affairs and Trade or Australian Department of Defence sponsored

Provide a letter of support

If your letter of support does not say it will meet the living costs and expenses of each secondary applicant, then evidence of sufficient funds is also required.

Secondary exchange student

Provide an Acceptance Advice of Secondary Exchange Student form

Postgraduate research student required to remain in Australia for marking of your thesis

Provide a letter from your education provider.

If you meet an exemption to apply for a Student visa in Australia

If you meet the course completion exemption, see **Meet an exemption to apply for a further student visa in Australia** in the Eligibility tab *(/Visa-subsite/Pages/student/500-student.aspx#Eligibility)*.

When you submit your application, you must provide:

- evidence of course completion via academic transcripts, or

- a letter from your provider.

Genuine Student documents

We will ask you to provide a response, in English, to a set of questions in your online application. Each question has a 150 word limit addressing the genuine student criteria. There is an additional question if you:

- have previously held a Student visa or
- are lodging an application in Australia from a non-student visa.

You will also need to attach supporting documents to your application in your ImmiAccount *(https://online.immi.gov.au/lusc/login)*.

See how to provide evidence to address the Genuine Student criteria *(/visas/getting-a-visa/visa-listing/student-500/genuine-temporary-entrant)*.

Student visa English language requirements

If required, provide evidence that you have either:

- obtained a minimum test score in an English language test approved by us, or
- met the requirements of an exemption category.

The table below shows the English language test providers and test scores taken on or before 6 August 2025. It includes information on English Language Intensive Courses for Overseas Students (ELICOS). It also states the minimum overall band scores you must achieve to meet the Student visa English language requirement.

English language test scores (Test taken on or before 6 August 2025)

Test Name	Minimum test score	Minimum test score if principal course is accompanied with either at least 10 weeks of ELICOS or a Foundation (Standard/Extended) program or an eligible Pathway program*	Minimum test score if principal course is accompanied by at least 20 weeks of ELICOS
International English Language Testing System (IELTS) *(https://www.ielts.org/)*	6.0	5.5	5.0
Test of English as a Foreign Language internet-based test (TOEFL iBT) *(https://www.ets.org/toefl/institutions/ibt/about.html)*	64	46	35
Cambridge English: Advanced (CAE) test/ Certificate in Advanced English *(http://www.cambridgeenglish.org/exams-and-tests/advanced)*	169	162	154
Pearson Test of English Academic (PTE) *(https://pearsonpte.com/the-test)*	50	42	36
Occupational English Test (OET) *(https://www.occupationalenglishtest.org/)*	B for each test component	B for each test component	B for each test component

*For a list of eligible Pathway programs, see Migration (English Language Tests and Evidence Exemptions for Subclass 500 (Student) Visas) Instrument 2025 - Federal Register of Legislation *(https://www.legislation.gov.au/F2025L00906/asmade/text)*.

Note: For packaged courses i.e. ELICOS and a Bachelor course, 10 weeks and 20 weeks of ELICOS is a 'minimum' requirement to meet the IELTS threshold. For example, an applicant who has enrolled in at least 10 weeks of ELICOS packaged with a principal course must have achieved the required IELTS (or equivalent) test score of 5.5. If enrolled in at least 20 weeks of ELICOS packaged with a principal course, the applicant must have achieved IELTS (or equivalent) test score of 5.0.

The table below shows the English language test providers and test scores taken on or after 7 August 2025. It includes information on English Language Intensive Courses for Overseas Students (ELICOS). It also states the minimum overall band scores you must achieve to meet the Student visa English language requirement.

English language test scores (Test taken on or after 7 August 2025)

Test Name	Minimum test score	Minimum test score if principal course is accompanied with either at least 10 weeks of ELICOS or a Foundation (Standard/Extended) program or an eligible Pathway program^	Minimum test score if principal course is accompanied by at least 20 weeks of ELICOS
C1 Advanced	161	Excluded*	Excluded*
CELPIP General	7	6	5
IELTS Academic	6.0	5.5	5.0
IELTS General Training	6.0	5.5	5.0
LANGUAGECERT Academic	61	54	46
MET	53	49	44
OET	1210	1090	1020
PTE Academic	47	39	31
TOEFL iBT**	67	51	37

* C1 Advanced test does not accept any test scores below IELTS 6.

** From **21 January 2026**, applicants must select **'Taking TOEFL for Australia**' during registration to ensure the test is valid for Australian visa purposes.

^For a list of eligible Pathway programs, see Migration (English Language Tests and Evidence Exemptions for Subclass 500 (Student) Visas) Instrument 2025 - Federal Register of Legislation *(https://www.legislation.gov.au/F2025L00906/asmade/text)*.

Note: For packaged courses i.e. ELICOS and a Bachelor course, 10 weeks and 20 weeks of ELICOS is a 'minimum' requirement to meet the IELTS threshold. For example, an applicant who has enrolled in at least 10 weeks of ELICOS packaged with a principal course must have achieved the required IELTS (or equivalent) test score of 5.5. If enrolled in at least 20 weeks of ELICOS packaged with a principal course, the applicant must have achieved IELTS (or equivalent) test score of 5.0.

You can find more information on Exemption categories and the English Language tests at Eligibility, Meet English language requirements *(/visas/getting-a-visa/visa-listing/student-500#Eligibility)*.

Evidence you have enough money for your stay

If the document checklist requires you to give evidence of your financial capacity, you must attach evidence with your visa application.

If you are required to attach evidence of your financial capacity to your ImmiAccount when you submit your application, you must do so. If you don't give this evidence, we may refuse your application without asking you for more information.

The document checklist may not indicate that you require evidence of your financial capacity, and you may not need to attach it when you submit your application. We may however still ask for this evidence while processing your application.

All subsequent entrants (family members who apply after we have granted you a visa) must attach evidence of financial capacity with their visa application. The document checklist is not relevant for subsequent entrants.

The living costs and expenses we ask you to declare for your visa application is the minimum amount of money you need for visa. Actual living costs vary across Australia. They may be much higher than what you need for the visa. We recommend you research the area you intend to live in, including the cost of living there.

For more information on evidence of financial capacity that satisfies the requirements specified in the Legislative Instrument, see the Federal Register of Legislation - Migration (LIN 19/198: Evidence of financial capacity—Subclass 500 Visa and Subclass 590 Visa) Instrument 2019 *(https://www.legislation.gov.au/F2019L01366/latest/text)*.

Evidence that you have enough money for your stay can include:

- deposits of money from a financial institution
- a government loan or loans from a financial institution
- scholarships or similar financial support.

Annual income

Alternatively, you can give evidence that your parents or your partner had a personal annual income of at least AUD87,856 in the 12 months before you apply. If you bring family members, your parents' or partner's income must be at least AUD102,500 in the 12 months before you apply.

If both your parents are working, we can consider their combined income. Give evidence of your parents' or partner's income in the form of official government documents such as tax assessments less than 12 months old. We won't accept bank statements or direct evidence from an employer.

Work out how much money you need for the visa

At a minimum, you must have enough money to pay for:

- your travel
- 12 months of your course fees (or pro rata fees, if your course is less than 12 months)
- 12 months of living costs for you and any family members who come with you to Australia (or pro rata fees, if you are staying less than 12 months)

- school fees for any school-age children who accompany you (or pro rata fees, if the child will be at school for less than 12 months).

Use the following information to work out how much money you need for the visa. To calculate pro rata costs, divide the annual cost by 365. Then multiply the result by the number of days you intend to stay in Australia.

Living costs

12-month living costs are for:

- students - AUD29,710
- partners coming with you - AUD10,394
- a child coming with you - AUD4,449.

Course fees

Use the first 12 months of your course fees. If your course is 12 months or less, use the total cost. Deduct any costs you have already paid –you must provide evidence you have paid them, such as a receipt or Confirmation of Enrolment.

If you are in Australia and your course has already started, calculate the course fee for 12 months starting on the date you lodge your application.

- Example 1: your course fee is AUD50,000 for 3 years. The fee for 12 months is the total course cost divided by the number of years you will be studying. AUD50,000 divided by 3 years = AUD16,666, less any amount you have already paid if relevant.
- Example 2: your course fee is AUD15,000 for 10 months and you have already paid AUD5,000. Deduct the amount you have already paid from the total amount. AUD15,000 - AUD5,000 = AUD10,000.
- Example 3: your course fee is AUD20,000 for 18 months. The fee for 12 months is the total divided by the total number of months, then multiplied by 12. (AUD20,000/18) x 12 = AUD13,333. Deduct any costs you have already paid.

Schooling costs

If you are including any school-age children in your application, add schooling costs of at least AUD13,502 per year for each child. Costs vary between states, territories and schools in Australia. You are responsible for finding out how much the child's schooling will cost.

You don't have to give evidence of schooling costs if you:

- are a PhD student and have enrolled your child in an Australian government school where the fees have been waived, or
- have received an Australian Commonwealth Government scholarship, including Foreign Affairs and Defence sponsored students, and have enrolled your child in an Australian government school where the fees have been waived.

You must give evidence the child is enrolled.

Travel costs

As a guide, when you calculate how much money you need, include:

- AUD2,500 for travel costs if you are applying from East or Southern Africa
- AUD3,000 for travel costs if you are applying from West Africa
- AUD2,000 for travel costs if you are applying from anywhere else outside Australia
- AUD1,000 for travel costs if you are applying in Australia. If you will be returning to Africa include AUD1,500.

For combined applications

Include the costs and expenses of the primary applicant. For family members also applying for the visa, include:

- 12 months living costs (or pro rata)
- any school fees
- travel expenses.

Other options

Secondary exchange students can prove they have enough money for their stay by providing a completed Acceptance Advice of Secondary Exchange Students (AASES) form.

Department of Foreign Affairs and Trade (DFAT) students can prove they have enough money for their stay by providing a letter of support from DFAT. They must also provide proof of the financial capacity of any family members travelling with them.

Department of Defence students can prove they have enough money for their stay by providing a letter of support from the Department of Defence. They must also provide proof of the financial capacity of any family members travelling with them.

Evidence you have genuine access to the money

If we ask you to give evidence of financial capacity, you must also prove you have access to it.

If someone else is providing you funds, give us:

- evidence of your relationship with them
- their identity documents
- evidence of any financial support they have given you or another Student visa holder in the past.

If you receive financial support through a business, show us proof the business is operating.

If you give evidence of deposits of money, explain their source to show how the funds were accumulated.

This could include supporting financial evidence, for example:

- recent bank transaction statements showing the history of funds
- any regular payments or growth patterns, such as from salary income.

Providing a bank balance certificate across a single day does not show us how you increased your funds.

Any education loan to cover your tuition or living costs should be paid out according to the agreement between you, the bank and the education provider. If you receive any payments before we

make a decision on your application, give us evidence including the terms of the loan and the full amount you will be paid.

If you are relying on another kind of loan, provide:

- evidence of the security you used
- the terms of the loan
- evidence you can cover ongoing costs.

The best evidence you can provide of genuine access to funds if you are relying on a loan is evidence of disbursement.

Let your provider know of any conditions on your education loan. Some loans offer deferred repayment against your future earnings. These loans can be conditional on you studying only a specified course with a certain provider.

Evidence you are exempt from paying a visa application charge (VAC):

The following Student visa applicants are not required to pay a visa application charge (VAC):

- Students awarded a scholarship funded by the Commonwealth Government of Australia
- Students and family members supported by the Department of Foreign Affairs and Trade
- Student and family members supported by the Department of Defence
- Secondary exchange students
- Students affected by education provider default and lodge a new Student visa application within 12 months of the provider default day
- Family members of students enrolled in a postgraduate research course
- Students affected by COVID-19 *(/visas/getting-a-visa/visa-listing/student-500#About)*.

If you are not sure, you should not claim exemption. We will not accept your application if you are not eligible and this may have consequences if you are in Australia. An invalid application outcome could affect your visa status and you may not be eligible if your visa has already expired to apply for a further visa.

Note:

- You are not Commonwealth sponsored if you are sponsored by the government in your home country or your government has provided you with a loan. Most Commonwealth sponsored students are enrolled in post graduate research courses.
- If your education provider is still operating but was unable to deliver the course you were enrolled in, then you are not affected by education provider default *(/visas/getting-a-visa/visa-listing/student-500/education-provider-default)*.

Overseas Student Health Cover

You **must** include proof of paid adequate health insurance for the proposed duration of your visa see Student visa grant periods *(/visas/getting-a-visa/visa-listing/student-500/length-of-stay)*.

Health insurance must be Overseas Student Health Cover (OSHC) covering everyone included in your application.

If you don't provide your OSHC in your application form, we will refuse your visa application.

If you or your agent have organised OSHC, and included this information on your CoE, you will need to include the name of your health insurance provider, the dates your policy starts and finishes and the policy number in your application form.

If your education provider arranged your OSHC, you will need to include the name of your health insurance provider and the dates your policy starts and finishes in your application. You do not need to include the policy number in your application.

Make sure there is no gap in your coverage if you are studying with more than one education provider and both providers arrange OSHC for you. The second policy must begin as soon as the first expires.

Note: If you are from Norway, Sweden or Belgium, you might not have to obtain OSHC. See information on exceptions in the 'Have adequate health insurance' section on the Eligibility *(/visas/getting-a-visa/visa-listing/student-500#Eligibility)* page.

Polio vaccination certificate

If you are applying from outside Australia and you are travelling from, or spent time in, a country considered at risk of polio, you need to give us a polio vaccination certificate.

See Threats to public health *(/help-support/meeting-our-requirements/health/threats-to-public-health#content-index-5)* for the current countries of risk.

Welfare arrangements and consent to grant a visa for students under 18

If you are applying for a Student visa and you are under 18 years old, you must have appropriate welfare arrangements in place. This must cover your period of stay or until you turn 18 years, whichever is first. You must also have consent from your parent(s) or guardian(s) to travel to and reside in Australia as an under 18 student.

If your nominated guardian is applying for a Subclass 590 Student Guardian visa *(https://immi.homeaffairs.gov.au/visas/getting-a-visa/visa-listing/student-590)*, both applications should be made at the same time.

Consent to grant a visa for a student under the age of 18 years

Every applicant under the age of 18 must provide a completed and signed consent Form 1229 (276KB PDF) *(/form-listing/forms/1229.pdf)* or a statutory declaration from each parent or legal

guardian with their consent. If you cannot provide consent form both parents or guardians, you will need to provide evidence that one party has sole custody.

You also need to provide:

- birth certificate of the under 18 student. The birth certificate must include the names of the parents. A ceremonial or notarial certificate is not sufficient for this purpose.
- identity document(s) that show the signature and photo of the person(s) who completed the form or declaration, such as a passport or driver's licence
- if applicable, evidence of sole custody such as a valid court order, death certificate or a divorce certificate/legal separation agreement.

Welfare arrangements

To show your welfare arrangements you must either:

- arrange a Confirmation of Appropriate Accommodation and Welfare (CAAW)
- provide your Acceptance Advice of Secondary Exchange Student (AASES) form if you are a secondary exchange student
- organise approval of your welfare arrangements from the relevant Minister, if you are a Foreign Affairs or Defence student or
- nominate a guardian

To nominate a guardian and for your Student visa to be valid, you must attach a completed Form 157N Student Guardianship Arrangements *(/form-listing/forms/157N.pdf)* to your applications. If your nominated guardian is applying for a Student guardian (subclass TU-590) visa, both applications should be made at the same time.

A nominated guardian must be:

- the parent of the Student visa holder or
- a person who has custody of the student or
- a relative of the student, aged 21 years or older, nominated in writing by a parent or person who has custody of the student.

A nominated guardian can have:

- Australian citizenship
- a permanent visa
- s substantive temporary visa for duration of the students stay or until they turn 18 or
- applied for or hold a subclass 590 visa.

For this visa, a relative is a:

- parent or step-parent
- grandparent or step-grandparent
- sibling or step-sibling or
- aunt, uncle, step-aunt or step-uncle.

You must include in your application:

- proof of relationship to the student, for example the birth certificate of the student, parent(s) and nominated guardian
- a police certificate for every country the guardian has lived in for more than 12 months in the last 10 years since turning 16 years, if not a parent/legal custodian
- a copy of the guardian's passport including biodata and signature page and
- evidence of residency in Australia if already a holder of a substantive visa
- a Form 157N Student Guardianship Arrangements (291KB PDF) *(/form-listing/forms/157N.pdf)*.

For more information see Welfare arrangements for students under 18. *(/visas/getting-a-visa/visa-listing/student-500/welfare-arrangements-students-under-18)*

Partner documents

If you are eligible to include your partner in your application, provide your partner's:

- identity documents
- character documents
- documents about other family members, if applicable

If you are married, provide your marriage certificate or other evidence that your marriage is valid in Australia.

If you are a de facto partner, provide documents that show you are in a de facto relationship.

Additional proof of a de facto relationship

In addition to documents proving your relationship provide evidence that:

- you have been in your de facto relationship for at least 12 months before you applied for this visa, or
- if applicable, provide evidence that your relationship is registered by a participating Australian state or territory

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Dependants under 18

If you are eligible to include dependents in your application, for every dependant child under the age of 18 years who is applying with you, provide:

- copies of birth certificates or the family book showing the names of both parents of all your dependent children
- copies of the adoption paper, if applicable.

If somebody other than your biological parents has legal guardianship over you (for example, adoptive parents or a court-appointed guardian), you must provide proof of their legal guardianship. This can be adoption papers or parental court orders, if applicable.

Parental responsibility documents

You must get consent for any applicant under 18 years of age to migrate to Australia from anyone who:

- has a legal right to decide where the child lives and
- is not coming to Australia with the child

They must complete either:

- Form 1229 Consent form to grant an Australian visa to a child under the age of 18 years (276KB PDF) *(/form-listing/forms/1229.pdf)*
- a statutory declaration giving their consent for the child to visit Australia on this visa

Alternatively, you can show us:

- an Australian court order that allows your child to migrate to Australia, or
- that the laws of your home country allow them to migrate

Include:

- an identity document that shows the signature and photo of the person who completed the form or declaration, such as a passport or driver's licence
- adoption papers or other court documents if applicable

Evidence of school enrolment

You must give us evidence of education for any dependant child who has turned 5 but has not turned 18 years.

This can be a letter from the school (public or private) or from the State/Territory education department where you will be studying and include enrolment details and fees paid.

Children 18 years and over

Only unmarried children under the age of 18 can be included as a dependant in your application.

If you have a child 18 or over, or a child who will turn 18 years before your Student visa is granted they will need to apply for their own visa.

Tell us you are getting help

To nominate someone to:

- receive your correspondence, use Form 956A Appointment or withdrawal of an authorised recipient (301KB PDF) *(/form-listing/forms/956a.pdf)*
- provide immigration assistance, use Form 956 Appointment of a registered migration agent, legal practitioner or exempt person (308KB PDF) *(/form-listing/forms/956.pdf)*.

Upload your written notification or your forms to ImmiAccount *(/help-support/applying-online-or-on-paper/overview)*.

Prepare your documents

Translate

Have all non-English documents translated into English.

Translators in Australia must be accredited by the National Accreditation Authority for Translators and Interpreters *(http://www.naati.com.au)*.

Translators outside Australia do not have to be accredited. But on each translation, they must include their:

- full name
- address and telephone number
- qualifications and experience in the language they are translating

These details must be in English.

Note: You do not need to have any documents certified.

Scan or photograph

Scan or photograph all documents (English and non-English) in colour.

The scans and photos must be legible.

If a document is more than 1 page, save it all as 1 file.

Keep

Keep a copy of your completed application.

Step 3

Apply for the visa

You must apply for this visa online. Most applicants must apply from outside Australia. You can only apply in Australia if you hold an eligible visa and meet an exemption category.

You should submit a complete and decision-ready application. Applications that are lodged without relevant documentation may be refused or delayed. The application form in ImmiAccount tells you what documents to attach.

If you are in Australia

You can't apply for a student visa in Australia if you hold a:

- Subclass 400 – Temporary Work (all streams)
- Subclass 403 – (Domestic Worker – Diplomatic/Consular stream)
- Subclass 407 – Training (all streams)
- Subclass 408 – Temporary Activity (all streams)
- Subclass 417 – Working Holiday (all streams)
- Subclass 457 – Temporary Work (all streams)
- Subclass 462 – Work and Holiday (all streams)
- Subclass 482 – Skills in Demand / Temporary Skill Shortage (all streams)
- Subclass 485 – Temporary Graduate
- Subclass 600 – Visitor
- Subclass 601 – ETA
- Subclass 602 – Medical Treatment
- Subclass 651 – eVisitor
- Subclass 771 – Transit
- Subclass 988 – Maritime Crew
- Subclass 995 – Diplomatic (Temporary) (Primary only. A family member of a Diplomatic (Temporary) visa (subclass 995) can apply for a Student visa in Australia).

If you hold one of the visas on this list there are no exemptions to these rules.

You may be able to apply for another Student visa while in Australia if you are a student visa holder.

Dependent student visa holders are unable to apply for a student visa as the primary applicant while in Australia.

For more information, see **Meet an exemption to apply for a further student visa in Australia** in the Eligibility tab *(/visas/getting-a-visa/visa-listing/student-500#Eligibility)*.

If you don't hold a substantive visa you may apply for a student visa within 28 days of holding a special purpose visa or a dependent Diplomatic (temporary) visa.

You may also apply for a student visa in Australia within 28 days of being notified of an Administrative Review Tribunal (ART) decision if:

- your last substantive visa was a student visa
- your Student visa was cancelled

- the Student visa had already ceased by the time the ART set aside the cancellation decision
- you meet one of the exemptions to lodge a student visa application in Australia.

You cannot make a valid application for a Student visa if you:

- do not hold a substantive visa, and
- you have previously been granted a visa based on an application made when you did not hold a substantive visa.

Do not provide false and misleading information

Provide accurate information. See what happens if you can't prove your identity or don't provide true information *(/help-support/meeting-our-requirements/providing-accurate-information)*.

Apply online

1. Create or log in to ImmiAccount *(https://online.immi.gov.au/lusc/login)*
2. Attach documents *(/help-support/applying-online-or-on-paper/online)*
3. Pay the visa application charge *(/help-support/applying-online-or-on-paper/online/how-to-pay)*

Paying the application charge

When you submit your application you must:

- pay for you and your family members or your application will not be valid
  or
- provide proof of exemption as shown in 'Step by step', Gather your documents.

If your visa cancellation was set aside by the Tribunal you can't apply online. Instead submit a ImmiAccount technical support form *(/help-support/departmental-forms/online-forms/immiaccount-technical-support-form)*.

Note: a valid application must be made within the eligibility timeframe as late applications will not be accepted.

See how to resolve error messages when submitting online *(/help-support/applying-online-or-on-paper/online/common-issues-and-error-messages)*.

Note:

If you are eligible to include dependents in your application, we cannot grant a Student visa to your child if they are 18 years or over at the time your visa is finished. Instead, they should apply for their own visa.

Step 4

After you apply

See what you can and must do after you apply.

You should respond to any requests for information promptly. You do not need to wait until the deadline to respond to a Departmental request for further information. You should also regularly log into your ImmiAccounts to check for messages from the Department and respond promptly.

You should avoid booking travel before your visa has been finalised.

Status updates

Do not contact the department if your application is within standard processing times *(/visas/getting-a-visa/visa-processing-times/global-visa-processing-times)*. We can't give any further updates on the application's progress. You can see if we have asked for more information in your ImmiAccount *(/help-support/applying-online-or-on-paper/online)*. You can also review Student visa processing priorities *(/visas/getting-a-visa/visa-processing-times/visa-processing-priorities/student-visa)*.

Maintain Enrolment

If you provided a Confirmation of Enrolment (CoE) with your application as evidence of enrolment in study, you must hold a valid CoE when we decide your student visa application.

A CoE is no longer valid if it is cancelled or the course is complete. To remain eligible for a student visa a new CoE will need to be attached to ImmiAccount.

Biometrics

We might ask for biometrics. Most applicants will be advised immediately after submitting an application if you need to provide biometrics. You will receive a letter and will also be able to see this request in your ImmiAccount. You will be given 14 days to provide biometrics so it is important to arrange an appointment quickly using the instructions in the request letter.

You must provide biometrics before travelling to Australia.

Health exams

If you did not have health examinations *(/help-support/meeting-our-requirements/health)* before you applied, check ImmiAccount to find out if you need them.

See the medical referral letter with your Health Assessment Portal (HAP) ID and further directions in ImmiAccount *(https://online.immi.gov.au/ola/app)*.

Stay lawful in Australia

Make sure you stay lawful by holding a valid visa while we process your application.

If you were in Australia when you applied for this visa, you were granted a Bridging visa A (BVA). If your current visa expires before we decide on your application, the BVA will start. You can stay in Australia on the BVA while we process your new visa application. You cannot travel on the BVA - there is no right of return on this visa; it cancels on departure.

Do not cancel your current visa. If you do, you will:

- be staying in Australia unlawfully
- not be eligible for a Bridging visa A

Learn more about visa expiry *(/visas/visa-about-to-expire)*.

Travel after you apply

You applied outside Australia, because you were not eligible to lodge your application in Australia

If you lodged your application from outside Australia, because you were not eligible to lodge your application in Australia, you may travel to Australia on another valid visa while your Student visa application is being processed. You must comply with that visa's conditions.

If you applied from outside Australia, because you were not eligible to lodge your application in Australia, you must be outside Australia when the Student visa is granted. If you are in Australia when your visa is ready to be granted, we may ask you to leave Australia so processing can continue.

You will not receive a Bridging visa linked to an application lodged outside Australia.

You applied outside Australia, but you are eligible to lodge inside Australia

If you lodged your application from outside Australia, but you are eligible under an exemption to lodge your application inside Australia, you can be granted your student visa while you are in Australia. For more information, see Exemptions – for student visa holders.

To see if you can meet requirements to be granted a Bridging Visa A, go to: Subclass 010 Bridging visa A (BVA) *(/visas/getting-a-visa/visa-listing/bridging-visa-a-010)*.

You applied inside Australia, because you meet an exemption to lodge inside Australia

If you lodged your application in Australia, you do not have to tell us if you want to travel outside Australia while we process your application. This is because you can be outside Australia when we make a decision.

But if you leave Australia, make sure your visa allows you to return. If you have a Bridging visa A, it will cease if you leave Australia.

If you have a BVA and have substantial reasons for travel, then a Bridging visa B (BVB) *(/visas/getting-a-visa/visa-listing/bridging-visa-b-020)*enables return to Australia while your application is being processed.

To see if you can return on your current visa, check VEVO *(/visas/already-have-a-visa/check-visa-details-and-conditions)*.

Learn about visa expiry *(/visas/visa-about-to-expire)*.

Providing more information

Lodging a complete application will ensure your visa is not delayed. If you did not attach all your documents when you applied, attach them as soon as you can in ImmiAccount. The Department may finalise your application based on the information you provided when you first lodged your visa, so it is recommended that you lodge a complete application. You can attach a maximum of 60 documents. We might also ask you to provide more information.

Newborn children

Find out what to do if your child is born after you apply *(/change-in-situation/had-a-baby)*.

Mistakes on your application

Let us know as soon as you can.

Complete Form 1023 Notification of incorrect answers (168KB PDF) *(/form-listing/forms/1023.pdf)*

Or

If you currently have a visa application in ImmiAccount that is not yet finalised, sign into ImmiAccount and select 'Update Details' from the Menu option.

Choose 'Notification of incorrect answers' from the list and provide the correct information.

Help with your application

Let us know if you no longer want someone to:

- receive your correspondence - complete Form 956A Appointment or withdrawal of an authorised recipient (301KB PDF) *(/form-listing/forms/956a.pdf)*
- provide immigration advice - complete Form 956 Appointment of a registered migration agent, legal practitioner or exempt person (308KB PDF) *(/form-listing/forms/956.pdf)*.

Upload your written notification or your forms to ImmiAccount *(/help-support/applying-online-or-on-paper/overview)*.

For more information see Who can help you with your application *(/help-support/who-can-help-with-your-application/overview)*.

Tell us if things change

Things you need to let us know about include:

- you want to withdraw your application
- changes to your phone number, address or passport
- changes to your relationship status
- the birth of a child
- changes to your welfare arrangements.

See how to tell us if your situation changes *(/change-in-situation)*.

Education provider default

Education provider default occurs when a registered education provider in Australia:

- closes, or
- can't deliver your course because they have been sanctioned

If after lodging your Student visa application your provider has defaulted, you will need to provide a new CoE for a new education provider.

See more about education provider defaults *(/visas/getting-a-visa/visa-listing/student-500/education-provider-default)*.

Step 5

Visa outcome

We will let you know in writing our decision about your visa application. We will tell you:

- your visa grant number
- the date your visa expires
- your visa conditions

Keep a copy of the decision with you when in Australia.

If we refuse your visa we will let you know in writing. We will tell you why we refused and whether you have a right to a review of the decision.

We will not refund the application charge if we refuse your application.

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12 October 2026